

Chapter 81-3

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The photoshoot with Zhao Ling went quite smoothly. Zhao Ling added her on WeChat through Zhao Xuning and also gave her an envelope—her payment.

Zhao Ling said: "It's not that I won't transfer money to you. I just prefer using cash. It gives the illusion of having a lot of money."

Liang Shi didn't mind and thanked him.

But Zhao Ling waved his hands in a fluster. "You're clearly the one who helped me out big time. I'll send you the original photos later. Also, this is for a class assignment and might be entered into a competition, so I wanted to let you know in advance."

Liang Shi nodded: "That's fine."

After leaving Qingyi University, Zhao Xuning accompanied her to the mall since it was on the way.

Liang Shi bought everything on her shopping list one by one and arranged for the furniture and appliances to be delivered to the designated location.

The delivery time was set for 7 PM.

That happened to be close to when the other party got off work. If she wasn't there at that time, Xu Qingzhu would be.

She also left both her and Xu Qingzhu's phone numbers with the mall.

The money she spent on shopping happened to be the payment Zhao Ling gave her—two thousand yuan.

For the amount that wasn't enough, she swiped her card.

Originally, Zhao Xuning wanted to pay, saying it was her apartment and she should be the one to furnish it, but Liang Shi stopped her.

Zhao Xuning didn't have the habit of fighting with others over the bill, so she let her be.

By the time they finished shopping at the mall, it was almost time for Liang Shi to go to work. She hurried to the company and happened to run into Liang Xinhe when she arrived.

Liang Xinhe looked haggard, holding a cup of coffee. His assistant followed behind him reporting on matters, while he was so tired he was yawning. When he saw Liang Shi, he asked: "Why are you coming from that direction?"

"Huh?" Liang Shi said, "I went to the mall."

The two stood side by side in the elevator. Seeing that his condition was really quite poor, Liang Shi asked with concern: "Are you sick?"

"Not me." Liang Xinhe said, "Our mom is sick."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, momentarily speechless, not even wanting to ask what illness it was.

"At least ask about it." Liang Xinhe had a tone of disappointment, like he was frustrated she wasn't living up to expectations.¹ "How can you not ask a single question?"

Liang Shi told him honestly: "I don't really want to know."

"How did our mom offend you?" Liang Xinhe said, "It was just one argument, wasn't it? How can there be overnight grudges between mother and daughter? How many nights has it been for you two now?"

Liang Xinhe was still lecturing her when, in the blink of an eye, she reached her floor. Just as she was about to get off the elevator and escape, Liang Xinhe changed the floor. "Come sit in my office for a bit."

Liang Shi: "..."

There was no escaping.

1. "Frustrated she wasn't living up to expectations" (恨鐵不成鋼) — A Chinese idiom literally meaning "hating iron for not becoming steel," expressing disappointment that someone isn't living up to their potential or isn't doing what they should be doing. ⇐